

UNCLASSIFIED

92

FIRST LOGISTIC AIR WING, ATLANTIC/CONTINENTAL

AIR TRANSPORT SQUADRON ONE

U. S. NAVAL AIR STATION

PATUXENT RIVER, MARYLAND

10 February 1951

UNCLASSIFIED

MEMORANDUM REPORT to Commanding Officer, Air Transport Squadron ONE

Subject: Report of Unusual Sighting on Flight 125/0, February 1951

1. At 0055Z, 10 February 1951, I was the Plane Commander of Flight 125/09, B-50 Bureau Number 56501, enroute from Keflavik, Iceland to Argentina, Newfoundland at 10,000 feet on an instrument flight plan. Our position at 10/0055Z was 49-50 North, 50-03 West, on a true heading of 230°, ground speed 118 knots. The weather was clear with about 60 miles visibility and thin stratus clouds at about 4,000.

2. I was in the cabin of the plane checking the passengers when one of the navigators, Lieutenant N. J. P. KOGER, came aft and pointed to this phenomena. I watched it for a minute and went forward to the cockpit to get a better view. Upon reaching the cockpit, I took the plane off of the auto-pilot and turned to a true heading of 290° in pursuit of the object. The object left on a heading of about 290° true and went over the horizon in a very short time.

3. I would guess the speed to be well over 1500 miles per hour, and the diameter to be at least 300 feet.

4. My first view of it resembled a huge fiery orange disc on its edge. As it went further away, the center became darker, but the edge still threw off a fiery hue. When it went over the horizon, it seemed to go from a vertical position to a horizontal position, with only the trailing edge showing in a half-moon effect. Since I was not the first to see it, it was going away from the plane when I was notified. Copilot Lieutenant G. E. BETHUNE was flying the plane and Second Plane Commander Lieutenant Fred KINGDON was flying on the right side at the time of the incident.

5. At 10/0104Z, I called Gander Tower on VHF and asked them if Gander A. T. C. had any information of an aircraft at that position and time. They had no such information and notified the military of our sighting. When we landed at Argentina at 10/0240Z, we were interrogated by Capt. D. E. PAULSEN, USAF, Pepperell AFB, and CDR WHEMEYER, C.O., VP-3, Argentina. The extreme speed, maneuverability, and brilliance of the object made our estimates as to the distance and size very difficult.

/s/A. L. JONES

LTJG, US. S. NAVY

UNCLASSIFIED

DOWNGRADED AT 3 YEAR INTERVAL  
DECLASSIFIED AFTER 12 YEARS

UNCLASSIFIED

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FLEET LOGISTIC AIR WING, ATLANTIC/CONTINENTAL  
AIR TRANSPORT SQUADRON ONE  
U. S. NAVAL AIR STATION  
PATUXENT RIVER, MARYLAND

10 February 1951

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~~CONFIDENTIAL~~

MEMORANDUM REPORT to Commanding Officer, Air Transport Squadron ONE

Subj: Report of Unusual Sighting on Flight 125/9 February 1951

1. I was navigator on Flight 125/09 from Keflavik, Iceland to NAS, Argentia.

2. At approximately 0050z/10 February 1951, I was reporting our position and ETA Argentia to the Pilot, Lieutenant KINGDON. At that time we were on a true heading of 230°, true air speed 190 knots, and a ground speed of 120 knots due to a 70 knot headwind.

3. Lieutenant KINGDON pointed out an orange colored object about 0600° relative, or 290° true, saying it appeared like a small village or a ship. Due to our position, I was certain it wasn't a village.

4. I had been looking at the object about thirty seconds, which it appeared to me was another demonstration of the "northern lights" phenomena which occur at that latitude, when the object suddenly started getting much brighter, taking on shape and coming in our direction at a great rate of speed. Before getting a good view of the object, I left the cockpit to inform LTJG JONES. Due to the crowded cockpit, I did not get another look.

5. The best view I had of the object showed it to be a circular, bright orange-red disc, which was approaching us at a very great, undeterminable speed.

/s/ NOEL J. P. KOGER  
LT, U. S. NAVY

ENCLOSURE (3)

UNCLASSIFIED

DOWNGRADED AT 3 YEAR INTERVAL

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AIR TRANSPORT SQUADRON ONE  
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MEMORANDUM REPORT to Commanding Officer, Air Transport Squadron ONE

Subj: Report of Unusual Sighting on Flight 125/9 February 1951

On February 10, 1951, enroute from Keflavik, Iceland to Argentia, Newfoundland as a crew member on flight 125 a strange sight was witnessed by Lieutenant KINGDON and Lieutenant BETHUNE who were piloting the aircraft at the time. I had left the cockpit approximately 1 hour prior to this sighting. The time of the sighting was 0055Z and the position of the aircraft was 49°-50N Lat and 50-03W Longitude. I was called to the cockpit by Lieutenant KINGDON to witness this scene.

When I first saw the sight it was far away from us and rapidly disappearing over the horizon. Not being too familiar with flying in this particular area my first impression was the celestial setting of the moon and the fact that stratus layers were present to cause the bright red glow and the halo effect that was apparent.

I did not witness the entire proceedings as did some of the other pilots, but from what little I did see of it this was the impression I received. The object disappeared on a true course of approximately 290°.

/s/ John M. MEYER  
LT, U. S. Navy.

ENCLOSURE (5)

DOWNGRADED AT 3 YEAR INTERVAL

UNCLASSIFIED - DECLASSIFIED AFTER 10 YEARS

UNCLASSIFIED

FLEET LOGISTIC AIR WING, ATLANTIC/CONTINENTAL  
AIR TRANSPORT SQUADRON ONE  
U. S. NAVAL AIR STATION  
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MEMORANDUM REPORT to Commanding Officer, Air Transport Squadron ONE

Subj: Report of Unusual Sighting on Flight 125/9 February 1951

When flight NM125 departed Keflavik, Iceland for Argentia, Newfoundland I had the first radio watch for the first 5½ or 6 hours. After being relieved of the watch by Reed, M. E., ALAN I went aft in the Passenger Compartment and went to sleep. After being asleep for awhile I heard someone say something about an object or something to the starboard of the aircraft. I raised my head to the window and saw a round object which to me looked like it was round with a color of fire. I didn't see it only for a few seconds then it was gone.

/s/Quentin R. SHIEVER,  
ALC, U. S. NAVY

ENCLOSURE (5)

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MEMORANDUM REPORT to Commanding Officer, Air Transport Squadron ONE

Subj: Report of Unusual Sighting on Flight 125/9 February 1951

We were off the coast of Newfoundland about 2 hours on flight 125 from Iceland on the 9th of February 1951, when I went forward to find out if the pilots or crew would like any coffee, soup, or etc. When I entered the cockpit compartment the co-pilot called my attention to a light at about 2 O'Clock and slightly lower than us. It looked very much like an eclipse of the sun, which was about three-fourths of total eclipse, in size, shape, and color, but the speed of the light must have been at least 520 knots if not more. The distance the light seemed to be was from three-quarters to a mile away. At that time Mr. JONES came forward and I went aft with the passengers.

/s/ Gerald R. DANIELS  
AE3, U. S. Navy.

ENCLOSURE (7)

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